The examination is being carried out on the **following application documents**

Description, Pages

1-23 filed with entry into the regional phase before the EPO

Claims, Numbers

1-7 filed with entry into the regional phase before the EPO

Drawings, Sheets

1/7-7/7 filed with entry into the regional phase before the EPO

1 Prior art

Reference is made to the following documents; the numbering will be adhered to in the rest of the procedure.

D1 US 2019/004254 A1 (YOSHINO MASAHIRO [JP] ET AL) 3 January 2019 (2019-01-03)

D2 US 2002/081077 A1 (NAULT PATRICK JUDE [US]) 27 June 2002 (2002-06-27)

D3 US 5 588 079 A (TANABE TAKASHI [JP] ET AL) 24 December 1996 (1996-12-24)

2 Independent claim

2.1 The present application does not meet the requirements of Article 52(1) EPC, because the subject-matter of claim 1 is not new in the sense of Article 54(1) and (2) EPC, the reasons being the following:

2.2 The document D1 discloses all the features of claim 1 as follows (the references in parentheses applying to this document):

An optical connector comprising:
- an optical fiber including a glass fiber (1) and a resin coating (2) covering the glass fiber (§[0028]);
- a front end portion (Figure 1);
- a rear end portion positioned on a side opposite to the front end portion

(Figure 1);
- a ferrule assembly (60) including a ferrule (40) and a holding part (50+53+56), the ferrule being fixed to, of the optical fiber, a tip portion of the glass fiber exposed from the resin coating, a rear end portion of the ferrule being fixed to the holding part, the holding part being provided with a flange (53) (see Figures 4 and 5);
- a housing (30) including (see Figure 6)

* an inner wall surface (34),

* a reference surface (34), and

* a positioning part (corners of hexagonal surface 34),

+ the inner wall surface defining an internal space (31) in which at least the holding part of the ferrule assembly is accommodated,

+ the reference surface constituting a part of the inner wall surface and being positioned to face a part of an outer peripheral surface of the flange (Figure 6),

+ the positioning part being provided for restricting a movement of the holding part in the internal space;

and
- an elastic member (80) configured to urge the flange toward the positioning part (see Figure 3),
wherein

* the reference surface includes two contact parts provided apart from each other by a predetermined distance and restricting a rotational direction of the flange as a result of a part of the outer peripheral surface of the flange contacting the contact parts (Figure 6).

2.3 In addition, D2 also discloses in Figures 1 and 2 a connector with all the claimed features as well as D3 in Figures 4 and 5.

3 Dependent claims

3.1 The dependent claims do not appear to contain any additional features which, in combination with the features of any claim to which they refer, meet the requirements of the EPC, the reasons being as follows:

3.2 Claim 2: See Figure 10 of D1 (Article 54 EPC).

3.3 Claim 3: See D2, Figure 17 (Article 54 EPC).

3.4 Claim 4: See Figure 1 of D1 (Article 54 EPC).

3.5 Claim 5: Flange 53 of D1 (Article 54 EPC).

3.6 Claim 6: "RD" in Figure 10 of D1 (Article 54 EPC).

3.7 Claim 7: Obvious design options for the skilled person (Article 56 EPC).

4 Formal objections

4.1 The features of the claims should be provided with reference signs placed in parentheses to increase the intelligibility of the claims (Rule 43(7) EPC).

4.2 The expression "which is hereby incorporated by reference" in §[0001] should be deleted from the description because the matter in the document referred to is not essential to satisfy the requirements of Art. 83 EPC (Guidelines F-III, 8).

4.3 The claim-like statements in the description from §[001] to §[0018] imply that the subject-matter for which protection is sought may be different to that defined by the claims, thereby resulting in lack of clarity of the claims (Article 84 EPC). These statements should therefore be omitted.

4.4 To meet the requirements of Rule 42(1)(b) EPC, the document D1 should be identified in the description and its relevant contents should be indicated. The applicant should ensure that it is clear from the description which features of the subject-matter of independent claims are known from the document D1.

5 Final remarks

5.1 The applicant is requested to file new claims which take account of the above comments.

5.2 When filing amended claims the applicant should at the same time bring the description into conformity with the amended claims. Care should be taken during revision, especially of the introductory portion and any statements of problem or advantage, not to add subject-matter which extends beyond the content of the application as originally filed (Article 123(2) EPC).

5.3 In order to facilitate the examination of the conformity of the amended application with the requirements of Article 123(2) EPC, the applicant is requested to clearly identify the amendments carried out, irrespective of whether they concern amendments by addition, replacement or deletion, and to indicate the passages of the application as originally filed on which these amendments are based.